

FREE DOWNLOAD

The Lead Vendor Vetting Checklist

10 questions to ask before you sign with any lead vendor.

Most agencies sign with a vendor after one good sales call. Don't. Ask these ten questions first. A real partner answers every one without flinching. A vendor dodges.

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01 Are these leads exclusive to me?

GOOD ANSWER: Yes. Sold once, to you, never resold. And they define exclusive in writing.

RED FLAG: Semi-exclusive. Ask how many agents get the same lead. If it is more than one, it is not exclusive.

02 How old is the lead when I get it?

GOOD ANSWER: Real time. Under five minutes from form fill to your CRM.

RED FLAG: Within 24 to 48 hours. That is an aged lead wearing a fresh-lead price tag.

03 Where do these leads actually come from?

GOOD ANSWER: They name the source. Our own ads. Our website. Specifics.

RED FLAG: Our network of partners. That means aggregators reselling other aggregators leads.

04 Can I see a full sample lead record?

GOOD ANSWER: Every field, timestamps, source tags. They show you before you pay.

RED FLAG: Name and phone number only. If they will not show you the data, the data is not worth buying.

05 What happens when a lead is bad?

GOOD ANSWER: A written replacement or credit policy. Disconnected, fake, duplicate, wrong vertical, all defined, with a process.

RED FLAG: We will look into it. That means no.

06 Show me your own funnel math.

GOOD ANSWER: They show CPL, contact rates, their own numbers. An operator has the math memorized.

RED FLAG: They cannot or will not. If a vendor cannot show you their own funnel math, walk away.

07 Who do I talk to when something breaks?

GOOD ANSWER: A named human with a direct line. You meet them before you sign.

RED FLAG: A support ticket queue. That is where the rep who disappeared the day after you signed went.

08 What is the minimum, the contract length, and how do I leave?

GOOD ANSWER: Short term, clear exit, no hostage clauses. Confidence looks like an easy out.

RED FLAG: Long lock-in with auto-renew. They need the contract because the leads will not keep you.

09 Can I talk to two current clients in my vertical?

GOOD ANSWER: Yes. This week. References without hesitation.

RED FLAG: We keep our clients confidential. Testimonials are marketing. References are proof.

10 What do you do that a vendor does not?

GOOD ANSWER: They describe partner behavior. Reporting you can read. Optimization they actually do. Math they show you.

RED FLAG: More promises. If they cannot name the difference, there is not one.

How to score it

8 to 10 good answers:

Worth a test budget. Start small, measure everything, scale what works.

5 to 7 good answers:

Proceed carefully. Get every promise in writing before you spend a dollar.

Under 5 good answers:

Walk away. There are better ways to spend the money.

Want a second set of eyes? Bring their answers to a free funnel teardown. I will read them with you and tell you straight whether the math works.

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